Most Popular Canteen Order

Coding Assignment - Problem 3 | Python

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Task: Return the most frequent item and count. Ties go to the item appearing first.
def mostPopular(orders):
counts = {}
for item in orders:
counts[item] = counts.get(item, 0) + 1
best_item = orders[0]
best_count = counts[best_item]
for item in orders:
if counts[item] > best_count:
best_item, best_count = item, counts[item]
return (best_item, best_count)

print(mostPopular(['dosa','idli','vada','dosa','idli','dosa','tea']))
print(mostPopular(['tea','coffee','coffee','tea']))

Output: ('dosa', 3); then ('tea', 2).
Hash-map method: average O(n) time, O(u) extra space for u unique items.
Repeatedly recounting every item by scanning all orders costs O(n^2) time.
```